Characterizing the academic OSPO in 2026

Overview

Here I am getting some background on the size and status of surveyed OSPOs.

Research questions:
- Where are university OSPOs located within their university?
- How many of the organizations have an OSPO or dedicated OSPO staff? How many organizations just have staff doing OSPO-like work as part of another role?
- How old are the OSPOs?
- How big are the OSPOs?
- What fraction of OSPO contributors are volunteers?

Relevant survey questions:
- Which best describes the open source function at your organization?
- What is the open source enabling function called within your organization?
- Where is your OSPO located within your university?
- How long has your OSPO been operating?
- Roughly how much total staff time is formally spent on OSPO or OSPO-like activities in your organization?
- Beyond that, roughly how many people regularly spend time on OSPO activities without being formally resourced?